Eunsol Cho

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Benson Hall C425, Terry College of Business, University of Georgia, Athens, GA
Republic of Korea citizen | U.S. permanent resident
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Research Interests

Behavioral economics in information systems; human-AI interaction; LLM advisors and agentic AI; decision-making under uncertainty and ambiguity; consumer bias and welfare; field and online experiments; econometrics; multimodal information

Academic Appointments

University of Georgia, Terry College of Business Aug 2026 - Present
Limited-Term Assistant Professor, Department of Management Information Systems Athens, GA

Education

New York University (NYU), Stern School of Business Aug 2020 - Aug 2026
Ph.D. in Information Systems, Technology, Operations, & Statistics Department New York, NY
- Dissertation: "Economic Decision-Making with Large Language Model Advice: Empirical Evidence on Trust and Welfare"

Korea Advanced Institute of Science & Technology (KAIST) Feb 2018 - Feb 2022
M.Sc. in Management Engineering, College of Business Seoul, Korea
- Double majored in IT Management & Green Management
- Master's thesis: "Essays on Economic Analysis of IT-enabled Markets: Implications for the Media and Energy Industries"

Korea Advanced Institute of Science & Technology (KAIST) Feb 2013 - Feb 2018
B.Sc. in Industrial Design Daejeon, Korea
- Concentration in Human-Computer Interaction

Korea Science Academy of KAIST Feb 2010 - Feb 2013
Specialized high school for gifted STEM students (concentration in Chemistry) Busan, Korea

Job Market Paper

Decision Complexity and Trust in Large Language Model Advisors
Eunsol Cho, João Sedoc, and Arun Sundararajan
- In preparation for submission to *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*
- Presented at Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference (May 2025), BizAI Conference (Mar 2025)
- Abstract: As organizations increasingly adopt large language models (LLMs) for decision support, a central challenge lies in understanding when individuals are willing to trust such advisors. We theorize that decision complexity plays a critical role, as it simultaneously increases the need for guidance while reducing individuals' ability to evaluate explanations. In a preregistered, incentive-compatible online experiment (N = 1,003) in a financial advising context, participants make investment decisions before and after receiving advice from an LLM. Complexity is manipulated through the number of lottery outcomes, and behavioral trust is measured using the weight-of-advice metric. We find that behavioral trust in LLMs increases with decision complexity, but only among individuals with higher cognitive reflection; for others, the effect attenuates due to reduced understanding of the LLM's reasoning. Our results extend behavioral trust measures to conversational agents and highlight the alignment between decision demands and user capabilities as critical for effective human-AI collaboration.

Papers Under Review

Catchy or Sketchy? How Thumbnail-Title Congruence Shapes Curiosity and Video Viewership
Eunsol Cho, Jaeung Sim, Daegon Cho, and Jiyong Eom
- Under review at *MIS Quarterly*

- Earlier versions presented at INFORMS Annual Meeting (Oct 2025), CIST (Oct 2023), WITS (Dec 2021)
- Abstract: On video-sharing platforms, users decide what to watch based on a small set of cues jointly signaling a video's content. We examine how the title's semantic congruence with each thumbnail component, its image and overlaid text, shapes viewership. A field study of 10,098 YouTube videos from 233 creators reveals a modality asymmetry: image-title congruence is positively associated with subsequent views, whereas text-title congruence is negatively associated with them. Drawing on information-gap theory, we propose that congruence shapes both the perceived information gap and its expected resolvability through viewing. A preregistered experiment with 996 participants, using generative AI to manipulate both forms of congruence, supports this account: image-title congruence enhanced curiosity and video choice, whereas text-title congruence did not, and the information gap increased curiosity only when expected resolvability was high.

Working Papers

LLMs and Consumer Bias: "Paying Not to Go to the Gym" with an LLM Advisor?
Eunsol Cho, Sagit Bar-Gill, and João Sedoc

- Accepted for long-paper presentation at the Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE), Lisbon, Portugal (Dec 2026)
- Abstract: LLM advisors increasingly interact with consumers at the point of purchase, raising the question of whether they mitigate or reinforce well-documented choice biases. We study gym membership choice, where consumers systematically overestimate future attendance. In a randomized field experiment with NYU Athletics, prospective members receive information through static disclosure or interact with one of two LLM advisors given matched information. The advisor does not change plan choice at purchase, but members advised by an LLM given historical usage data overspend $17.7 more per month than those advised by a pricing-only LLM. Conversation-level analysis, an online replication (N = 687), and a digital-twin experiment show that the advisor reinforces, rather than challenges, users who are highly confident and whose estimates lie far above break-even, and that access to historical usage data increases reinforcement. The findings inform the design and regulation of consumer-facing AI advisors.

Reinforcement versus Challenge in LLM-Assisted Decision-Making
Eunsol Cho, Sagit Bar-Gill, and João Sedoc

- Abstract: LLM advisors may either challenge or reinforce the beliefs users bring to a decision. We develop a method for evaluating whether an LLM advisor reinforces or challenges a user's existing belief, a construct distinct from tone, grounded in a conceptually defined rubric validated against expert human judgment and applied at scale. Focusing on settings in which consumers estimate their own future usage and tend to be biased, gym memberships and prepaid eSIM data plans, we show that the method generalizes across settings, providing a tool for evaluating whether an LLM offers a meaningful second opinion or accepts users' assumptions without scrutiny.

Redefining Objectives Under Algorithmic Ambiguity: Addressing Ambiguity Aversion through Regularization
Eunsol Cho

- Abstract: Organizations increasingly deploy predictive models in settings where users differ in their tolerance for uncertainty about model performance. Using the α-Maxmin Expected Utility framework, I theorize that regularization induces a trade-off between the mean and the across-dataset variance of out-of-sample errors, and that ambiguity-averse users will favor objectives that temper variance even at some cost to the mean. Simulations on synthetic data show that the α-MEU objective selects different regularization levels across ambiguity attitudes, whereas in simulations seeded by a real-world meal-delivery dataset the objective becomes monotone in regularization, yielding the same choice across attitudes. The findings suggest that user-centric objective tuning can be a useful design lever and identify conditions under which ambiguity attitudes shape model preferences.

Presentations and Invited Talks

Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE) Dec 2026
"LLMs and Consumer Bias: 'Paying Not to Go to the Gym' with an LLM Advisor?" (accepted, long paper)
Eunsol Cho, Sagit Bar-Gill, and João Sedoc Lisbon, Portugal

INFORMS Annual Meeting Oct 2025

"Rational Analysis of Curiosity and Information Modality in Video Representations"
Eunsol Cho, Jaeung Sim, Jiyong Eom, and Daegon Cho — Atlanta, GA

Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference — May 2025
"Decision Complexity and Trust in Large Language Model Advisors"
Eunsol Cho, João Sedoc, and Arun Sundararajan — Philadelphia, PA

BizAI Conference @ UT Dallas — Mar 2025
"Decision Complexity and Trust in Large Language Model Advisors"
Eunsol Cho, João Sedoc, and Arun Sundararajan — Dallas, TX

Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST) — Oct 2023
"Information Congruence of Multimodal Previews and Online Video Success: Evidence from YouTube"
Eunsol Cho, Jaeung Sim, Jiyong Eom, and Daegon Cho — Phoenix, AZ

Symposium on Statistical Challenges in Electronic Commerce Research (SCECR) — Jun 2022
"From App to Super App: The Impact of Complementary Innovation on Platform Ecosystem"
Eunsol Cho, Anindya Ghose, and Raveesh Mayya — Madrid, Spain

Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics — Dec 2021
"All-in-one Platform: An Empirical Study on the Impact of Complementary Innovation in Digital Platforms"
Eunsol Cho, Anindya Ghose, and Raveesh Mayya — Virtual

Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS) — Dec 2021
"Information Congruence of Multimodal Previews and Online Video Success: Evidence from YouTube"
Eunsol Cho, Jaeung Sim, Jiyong Eom, and Daegon Cho — Austin, TX

International Association for Energy Economics (IAEE) Annual Conference — Jun 2019
"Contract Design for Service Reliability Management based on Demand-Side Flexibility"
Eunsol Cho and Jiyong Eom — Montreal, Canada

Teaching Experience

MIST 4600: Computer Programming in Business (undergraduate) — Fall 2026
Instructor, University of Georgia, Terry College of Business

Causal Inference (graduate) — Fall 2023
Teaching Assistant, NYU Stern School of Business

Information Technology in Business and Society (undergraduate) — Summer 2023
Instructor (Instructor evaluation: 4.38/5), NYU Stern School of Business

Information Technology in Business and Society (undergraduate) — Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, NYU Stern School of Business

Predictive Modeling Using R (graduate) — Summer 2022
Teaching Assistant, NYU Stern School of Business

Machine Learning Applications to Samsung Cases (professional) — Oct 2019
Teaching Assistant, Samsung Group Education Program (Program Chair: Dr. Yoonho Cho, Kookmin University)

Introduction to Machine Learning (professional) — Sep 2019
Teaching Assistant, Samsung Group Education Program (Program Chair: Dr. Yoonho Cho, Kookmin University)

Grants and Awards

Ph.D. Research Grant ($2,000) — 2025
NYU Center for Global Economy and Business

Dissertation Research Funding ($3,650) — 2025
NYU Stern School of Business

Ph.D. Fellowship — 2020 - 2026
NYU Stern School of Business

Travel Grant (IAEE Annual Conference) — 2019
Graduate School of Green Growth, KAIST College of Business

National Scholarship for Graduate Students 2019
Korea Student Aid Foundation; for excellence in research proposal

Master's Fellowship for Double Major 2018 - 2019
Graduate School of Green Growth, KAIST College of Business

Undergraduate Research Participation Fellowship 2016
KAIST

National Scholarship for Science and Engineering 2013 - 2018
Korea Student Aid Foundation; for excellence in academic performance

Gold Medal (1st prize, $3,000 grant) in Life Science 2012
Asia Pacific Conference of Young Scientists

Scholarship for Excellence in Mathematics 2010 - 2012
Woongjin Foundation

Silver Medal, Korean Mathematical Olympiad (Junior Division) 2009
Korean Mathematical Society

Silver Medal, Korean Chemistry Olympiad (Junior Division) 2008
Korean Chemical Society

Academic Service

Discussant Dec 2025
Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE)

Ad-hoc Referee 2020 - Present
International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS); Pacific Asia Conference on Information Systems (PACIS)

ISPOC Organizer 2022 - 2024
Main Organizer (2023-24), Associate Organizer (2022-23); Ph.D. student seminar series in IS

Skills and Languages

Programming: Python, R, Stata, Java, JavaScript, LaTeX
Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent)

References

João Sedoc
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Sagit Bar-Gill
Assistant Professor (Senior Lecturer) with Tenure, Technology Management and Information Systems
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